Visitor Policy

Version: 1.0 | Effective: [Insert Date] | Review: [Insert Date]

Visitor Policy

Policy Statement

At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], we recognise the importance of maintaining strong connections between residents, their families, friends, and the wider community. Visitors are welcomed and encouraged, as they play a vital role in supporting residents' wellbeing, dignity, and quality of life. This policy ensures that visits are conducted in a safe, respectful, and well-managed way that protects the privacy, safety, and security of all residents and staff.

Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Promote and support safe visiting arrangements
- Balance open access with the need to protect residents' safety, dignity, and confidentiality
- Ensure compliance with safeguarding, health and safety, and regulatory requirements
- Provide clear guidance for visitors, residents, and staff

Scope

This policy applies to:

- All visitors to the care home (including family, friends, professionals, volunteers, and contractors)
- All staff responsible for facilitating and supervising visits where required

Roles and Responsibilities

Registered Manager:

- Oversees the implementation of the visitor policy
- Ensures that visiting arrangements comply with health, safety, and safeguarding requirements
- Reviews and updates visiting procedures as necessary

Staff:

- Welcome visitors in a friendly, professional manner
- Verify visitors' identity and purpose of visit
- Ensure visitors comply with infection prevention, safeguarding, and confidentiality rules

Visitors:

- Follow care home policies and respect the rights of residents, staff, and other visitors
- Refrain from disruptive behaviour or breaching confidentiality

- Report any concerns regarding residents' welfare to the Registered Manager or staff on duty

Visiting Arrangements

5.1 General Visitors (Family and Friends)

- Visiting hours are [Insert visiting hours], though flexibility may be provided in special circumstances (e.g., end-of-life care).
- Visitors must sign in and out in the visitors' log book or electronic system.
- All visitors must wear a visitor badge where required.
- Children are welcome but must be supervised at all times.

5.2 Professional Visitors

- Health professionals, regulators, and other professionals may visit with prior arrangement or in line with their duties.
- Identification must be shown on arrival.
- Records of visits must be maintained.

5.3 Contractors

- Contractors must be authorised and supervised as appropriate.
- Health and safety and infection prevention measures must be followed.

5.4 Infection Prevention and Control

- Visitors may be required to follow infection control procedures (e.g., hand hygiene, PPE, restrictions during outbreaks).
- Visits may be temporarily restricted or managed differently in the event of a public health risk (e.g., flu, COVID-19).

Safeguarding, Privacy, and Confidentiality

- Residents have the right to choose who visits them and to refuse visits if they wish.
- Visitors must respect residents' privacy, dignity, and confidentiality.
- Visitors are not permitted to take photographs, videos, or recordings of residents, staff, or the premises without consent.
- Any safeguarding concerns raised by visitors must be reported immediately to staff.

Restrictions and Exclusions

- Visitors under the influence of drugs or alcohol, or those behaving inappropriately, may be refused entry or asked to leave.
- Individuals who pose a safeguarding or security risk may be excluded.
- Any decision to restrict or ban a visitor will be made by the Registered Manager and recorded, with clear reasons provided.

Training and Awareness

- Staff will be trained to support safe and positive visiting arrangements.
- Residents and families will be informed of visiting policies and any temporary changes.

Monitoring and Review

- Visitor logs will be reviewed for security and safeguarding purposes.

- Feedback from residents, families, and visitors will inform future improvements.
- This policy will be reviewed annually or sooner if required by legislation or guidance.

References

- Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
- CQC Fundamental Standards – Regulation 10 (Dignity and Respect), Regulation 12 (Safe Care and Treatment)
- Safeguarding Adults Legislation and Guidance
- UKHSA Infection Prevention and Control Guidance

Related Policies

- Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Infection Prevention & Control Policy
- Privacy and Dignity Policy
- Confidentiality / GDPR Policy
- Health and Safety Policy

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